

Location: Giant's Causeway, Northern Ireland, United Kingdom

Figure 1

Photo of Giant's Causeway, courtesy of UNESCO



Figure 1- The site of Giant's Causeway is unique with the basalt rock formation protrusions, which indicates that lava flowed through the region in times past

Description of Giant's Causeway

Giant's Causeway is a natural area that contains hexagonal basalt columns that is in Northern Ireland, UK (*Encyclopedia Britannica*, 2025). The size of Giant's Causeway is about 70 hectares (or 0.7 km^2) for the landmass. However, for the entire site, which includes the shorelines, it's about 230 hectares (or about 2.3 km^2) (*Giant's Causeway and Causeway Coast*, 2025). Figure 2 below illustrates the clear boundary point below:

Figure 2

Boundary of Giant's Causeway, courtesy of Giant's Causeway and Causeway Coast

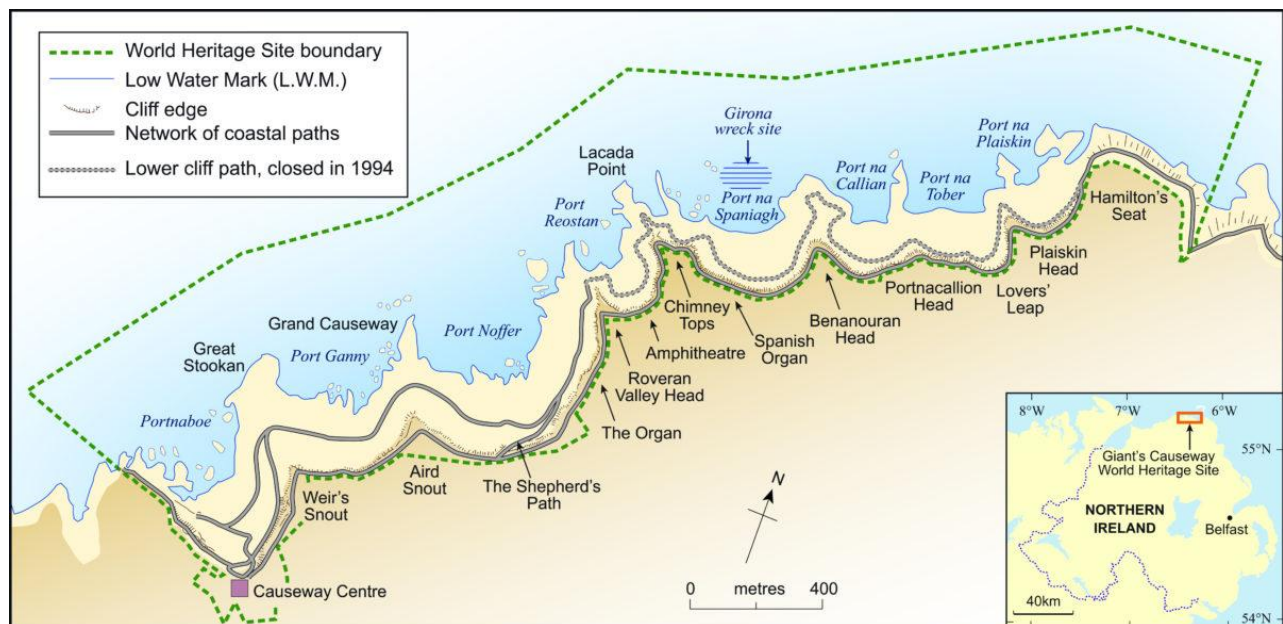


Figure 2 - Boundary site of Giant's Causeway. The cliff edges and lower cliffs could indicate where erosion happened, and there could have been more to the site than there is today.

The coordinates of Giant's Causeway are 55.24 in Latitude, -6.51 Longitude (*LatLong*, 2025). The relative location of the heritage site is about 40 km Northeast of Londonberry, the second most populous city of Northern Ireland (*Encyclopedia Britannica*, 2025). Figure 3 shows a Google Maps image of the location of Giant's Causeway relative to everything else:

Figure 3

Relative location of Giant's Causeway to everything else

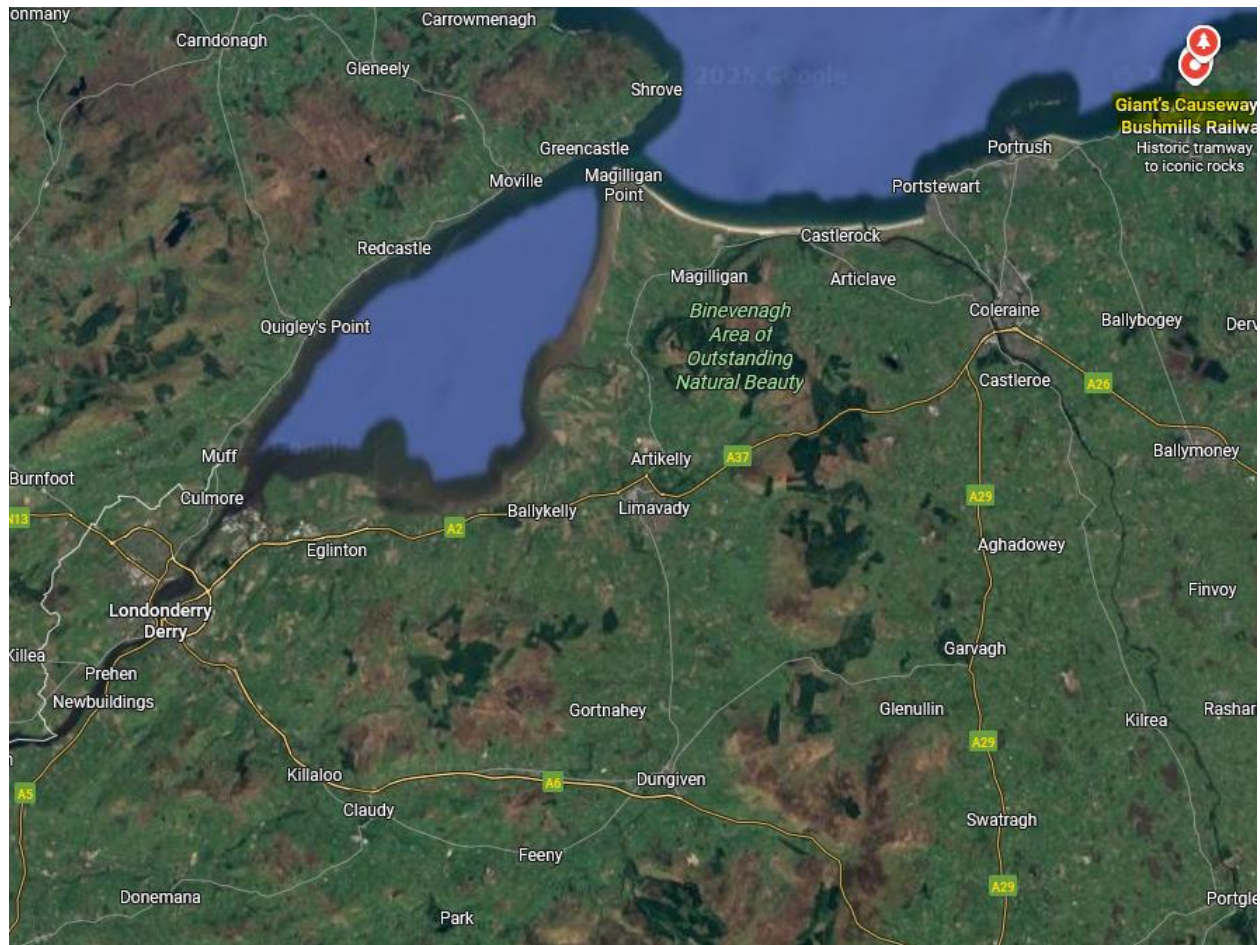


Figure 3 - Giant's Causeway in relation to other parts of Northern Ireland. Geologists sometimes must look at the surrounding areas to investigate whether formations are abnormal to the region or are typical to the region to see if there was a unique event that happened there

The key landmark that Giant's Causeway has would be the hexagonal basalt stones, as they are exceptional in shape and haven't been seen anywhere else in the world. The closest population would be Bushmill Villiage (3.2km), followed up by Coleraine (17.7 km) and Bally Castle (21 km) (*National Trust*, 2025). Giant's Causeway, as previously discussed, is in Northern Ireland. Northern Ireland borders in Ireland down south, and over the sea northeast is the mainland of the United Kingdom, where Wales and England are present. The nearest water body for the site would be the North Atlantic Ocean. Giant's Causeway unfortunately doesn't have any parks around it. However, there are many trails that run through the site for tourists to experience the grandeur of the basalt hexagonal columns.

Reasons For Choosing Giant's Causeway

There are a couple of reasons why I chose Giant's Causeway to be my specific site to do my assessment on. For starters, it met all the criteria that was outline by the requirements of the Study Site Assessment. Giant's Causeway is attached to the Earth's crust, as it's hexagonal basalt columns. The site, as mentioned, is only 2.3 km² max in size, accounting the official heritage site definitions. There is a clear boundary for Giant's Causeway, as illustrated in the description of the site. It does have a known geologic age based on the basalt formations – the Paleogene Period (*Encyclopedia Britannica*, 2025). The formation of Giant's Causeway was from lava, so it wasn't man-made. From that point, the site was not from a glacial or fluvial origin. Finally, there is much information surrounding Giant's Causeway that it would make it relatively not difficult to find the required info for the other two assessments. The other reason is because I have never seen basalt rocks form in a hexagonal pattern, and so I wanted to learn more about that fact. All these reasons attributed to choosing Giant's Causeway as the site for me to do my assessment on.

References

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